



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Berean Christian Academy
School Website: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Berean Christian Academy (Katy, TX)

School website used: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Why: Berean Christian Academy's public materials repeatedly emphasize transcendental moral realism ("Truth, Goodness, and Beauty"), a Christ-centered theological foundation, and a curriculum ordered to the liberal arts (Trivium) and Great Books. Upper School pedagogy features seminar dialogue (Harkness), formal logic and debate, and a Senior Thesis—clear rhetoric-stage markers. Parent partnership is explicitly named. While we did not find explicit references to liturgical practices, restful learning (scholé), or lower-school chanting/memory work in the provided crawl, the core signals across mission, curriculum, and upper-school pedagogy strongly align with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classicality lexicon .

Key evidence found in the crawl data: - "Christ-centered worldview," "recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," "for the glory of Christ" (mission) - "Independent, interdenominational, classical Christian school," ACCS and SCL memberships - "Seven liberal arts," "Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric," "Latin," "great books," "original ancient texts," "theology," "philosophy," "Harkness Table conversation," "formal logic and debate," "Senior Thesis," and "virtue development"

Method note: We scored the school against the Six Essential Elements positive/negative keyword indicators (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community) , cross-checked with the classicality lexicon , and applied the category criteria provided.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found in BCA materials (direct matches/phrases)

- truth, goodness, beauty; Christ-centered worldview; Christian; theology; wisdom; virtue; glory of Christ

2) Comparison to Six Elements indicators

- Positive indicators include truth, goodness, beauty, virtue/wisdom, and theological grounding (theology, Christian worldview) and in the lexicon list (truth/goodness/beauty; theology; catechesis; reverence) .
- We did not see explicit liturgical terms (e.g., chapel, liturgy, hymnody) in the crawl; however, theological integration is clearly present and consistent with viewing theology as the capstone/"queen" of the sciences in Christian classical education .

3) Tally (positive vs. negative keywords)

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- Positive hits (unique): 8 (truth; goodness; beauty; theology; Christ-centered; Christian; wisdom; virtue)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Estimated coverage of sub-areas (moral realism; theology; liturgical life): ~67% (clear on moral realism and theology; no explicit liturgy)

4) Justification

- Strong affirmations of the transcendentals and theological grounding align directly with the positive lists, with no conflicting language detected .
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found

- virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty; formation signals via “virtue development” and mentorships; “for the glory of Christ”

2) Comparison

- Positive indicators: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation vs. mere information .
- No utilitarian framing (e.g., “college and career readiness,” “21st-century skills”) was found; those are negative indicators in the lists .

3) Tally

- Positive hits (unique): 6 (virtue; wisdom; truth; goodness; beauty; “virtue development”)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Estimated coverage of sub-areas: ~80–90% (clear on virtue/wisdom and the transcendentals; formation implied through “virtue development,” though the exact term “formation” does not appear)

4) Justification

- The stated purpose centers on cultivating virtue and wisdom ordered to the transcendentals, matching the positive keyword sets well .
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found

- seven liberal arts; Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Latin; great books; original ancient texts; theology; philosophy; debate; rhetoric; Senior Thesis

2) Comparison

- Positive indicators: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books/primary sources; integrated, wonder-oriented learning .
- No “social studies” replacement of “history,” no STEM-first or project-based dominance (negative signals) were detected in the crawl .

3) Tally

- Positive hits (unique): 10 (seven liberal arts; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Latin; great books; original texts; theology; philosophy; Senior Thesis/debate/rhetoric)
- Negative hits: 0

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- Percent positive: 100%
 - Estimated coverage of sub-areas: ~75% (clear Trivium and Great Books; implicit history engagement via “ancient texts”; “wonder” not explicitly named)

4) Justification

- The curricular signals are robustly classical, directly mapping to the Trivium and Great Books indicators in the Six Elements and lexicon .
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CATEGORY 4: PEDAGOGY/TEACHING METHODS — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found

- Harkness Table conversation; formal logic and debate; rhetoric stage; Senior Thesis (rhetorical capstone)

2) Comparison

- Positive indicators: Socratic seminar/dialectic (includes Harkness), rhetoric exercises, orations/thesis work .
- Missing from the crawl: explicit references to lower-school chanting/recitation, restful learning/scholé, or “wonder” as a pedagogical aim—also positive signals in the Six Elements and lexicon .
- No negative pedagogy flags (e.g., “project-based only,” “experiential learning” dominance) were detected .

3) Tally

- Positive hits (unique): 5 (Harkness; logic; debate; rhetoric; Senior Thesis)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Estimated coverage of sub-areas: ~50% (upper-school dialectic/rhetoric strong; K–8 chanting/recitation and scholé not evidenced)

4) Justification

- Clear classical pedagogy in Upper School; limited explicit K–8 memory work/scholé mentions in the crawl. With K–12 schools, lack of explicit K–8 evidence does not preclude a classical pedagogy, but we mark this “Somewhat Classical” pending additional lower-school documentation.
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CATEGORY 5: FACULTY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found

- mentorships; “faculty are all degreed”; small class sizes for formation/feedback

2) Comparison

- Positive indicators: teachers as models/mentors, living curriculum, collegiality/portrait of a teacher/student .
- The crawl mentions mentorships, which aligns with the mentor/formation emphasis. It does not explicitly state “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” or “living curriculum.”

3) Tally

- Positive hits (unique): 1–2 (mentorship/mentors)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%

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- Estimated coverage: ~50% (mentoring present; teacher-portrait/collegium not seen)

4) Justification

- Evidence of mentoring is good; more explicit language that teachers are moral/intellectual exemplars and a “living curriculum” would strengthen alignment.
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CATEGORY 6: PARENTS & COMMUNITY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) Keywords found

- “Berean operates as a partnership between faculty and parents”

2) Comparison

- Positive indicators: partnership with parents/co-teachers; parent formation (book studies, seminars); open/hospitable visits .
- We saw explicit partnership language, but not explicit parent-education offerings or open-visit language.

3) Tally

- Positive hits (unique): 1 (parent partnership)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Estimated coverage: ~33% (partnership present; parent formation/open-campus not evidenced)

4) Justification

- Clear partnership statement; further public-facing parent-formation resources would improve alignment.
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Aggregate Rating: CLASSICAL

- Strongest alignment: Categories 1–3 (Religious/Theological foundation; Purpose/Aim; Curriculum) are clearly Classical with multiple direct positive keyword hits and no detected negatives, tracking the Six Essential Elements positive lists closely .
 - Moderating factors: Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community are “Somewhat Classical” only because the crawl did not surface explicit mentions of scholé/rest, chanting/recitation, teacher-portrait/collegial language, or parent-formation programs. None of these categories show negative signals; additional public documentation would likely lift these to “Classical.”
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Evidence Highlights (verbatim from the crawl)

- Mission: “educate students in a Christ-centered worldview, equipped to recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty in God’s Creation... operate as a partnership between faculty and parents... for the glory of Christ”
 - Program: “classical Christian school... time tested learning model of the seven liberal arts. The Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric stages... focus on math and Latin... formal logic and debate classes, Harkness Table conversation... great books, original ancient texts, theology, philosophy... Senior Thesis... virtue development, and mentorships.”
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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